

Grammar

Past Progressive: actions in progress in nature

We use the Past Progressive (was/were + verb-ing) to talk about an action that was in progress at a specific moment in the past. It shows what was happening 'at that time'.

Past Progressive (was/were + fiil-ing), geçmişte belirli bir anda devam eden bir eylemi anlatmak için kullanılır. Genellikle 'o sırada' ya da 'o anda' ne olduğunu göstermek için kullanılır.

When? We use it to describe what was happening in nature at a certain moment, for example what we were doing when the storm started.

Doğada belirli bir anda ne yaptığımızı anlatırken (örneğin, fırtına başladığında ne yapıyorduk) kullanılır.

Positive

- We were hiking along the trail.
- The birds were singing.

Negative

- It wasn't raining.
- We weren't sleeping.

Question

- Were you camping near the river?
- Was it raining when you left?

Short answers

- Yes, we were. / No, we weren't.
- Yes, it was. / No, it wasn't.

Common mistakes

- ~~We were hike along the trail.~~ → **We were hiking along the trail.**
- ~~She was sleep when the storm started.~~ → **She was sleeping when the storm started.**

1. At 7 a.m., we _____ along the trail.

- a. hike
- b. were hiking
- c. hiked

2. The birds _____ when the sun rose.

- a. were singing
- b. sang
- c. sing

3. It _____ when we set up camp.

- a. didn't rain
- b. wasn't raining
- c. isn't raining

4. _____ you camping near the river last weekend?

- a. Did
- b. Were
- c. Are

5. We _____ (cook) dinner over the campfire when it started to rain.

6. I _____ (not/sleep) when the storm woke everyone up.

7. The hikers were carry heavy backpacks up the hill. — *True / False*

8. We were watching the sunrise from the top of the cliff. — *True / False*

9. A: What _____ you _____ (do) at sunrise this morning?

10. B: I _____ (watch) the wildlife near the lake.

11. Make a question about last night's storm.

Past Progressive vs Simple Past: interrupted actions

When one action was in progress and a second, shorter action interrupted it, we use the Past Progressive for the longer action and the Simple Past for the shorter one. 'When' usually goes before the shorter action, and 'while' before the longer one.

Bir eylem geçmişte devam ederken başka bir eylem onu kesintiye uğratırsa, uzun süren eylem için Past Progressive, kısa/ani eylem için Simple Past kullanılır. 'When' genellikle kısa eylemden önce, 'while' ise uzun eylemden önce gelir.

When? We use it to say that something suddenly happened while we were doing an outdoor activity, for example seeing a deer while we were hiking.

Doğada bir aktivite sürerken aniden başka bir şeyin olduğunu anlatırken (örneğin yürüyüş yaparken bir geyik gördük) kullanılır.

Positive

- We were walking when we saw a deer.
- The storm started while we were camping.

Negative

- We weren't sleeping when the storm started.
- It wasn't raining when we left.

Question

- What were you doing when the storm started?
- Were you hiking when it began to rain?

Short answers

- I was reading a map.
- Yes, we were.

Common mistakes

- ~~We walked along the trail when we were seeing a deer.~~ → **We were walking along the trail when we saw a deer.**
- ~~While we were setting up the tent, the rain was starting.~~ → **While we were setting up the tent, the rain started.**

1. We _____ along the trail when we _____ a deer.

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- a. were walking / saw
 - b. walked / were seeing
 - c. were walking / were seeing

2. The rain started _____ we were setting up the tent.

- a. when
- b. while
- c. during

3. Lightning _____ a tree while we were hiding.

- a. was striking
- b. struck
- c. strikes

4. I was reading my compass _____ my friend called me.

- a. while
- b. when
- c. during

5. We _____ (cross) the river when the storm _____ (begin).

6. I _____ (not/watch) the wildlife when it _____ (start) to rain.

7. We were walking along the cliff when we were seeing the waterfall. — *True / False*

8. While we were camping, a storm began suddenly. — *True / False*

9. A: What _____ you _____ (do) when the flood _____ (start)?

10. B: We _____ (sleep) in our tent.

11. Make a sentence: hiking / saw / we / a waterfall / were / when

Could: past ability

Could is used to talk about a general ability in the past (something we were able to do, for example as a child). The negative is couldn't, and the question is Could + subject + base verb.

Could, geçmişte genel bir yeteneği anlatmak için kullanılır (örneğin çocukken yapabildiğimiz şeyler). Olumsuzuz couldn't, sorusu ise Could + özne + yalın fiil şeklindedir.

When? We use it to talk about general abilities in nature in the past, like being able to climb, swim, or find the way.

Doğada geçmişte yapabildiğimiz ya da yapamadığımız genel şeyleri anlatırken kullanılır: tırmanabilmek, yüzebilmek, yön bulabilmek gibi.

Positive

- My grandfather could climb mountains.
- The guide could find the cave in the dark.

Negative

- We couldn't see the trail.
- I couldn't start a campfire.

Question

Short answers

- Could you swim across the river? — Yes, I could. / No, I couldn't.
- Could they find shelter in time?

Common mistakes

- ~~We could to see the trail.~~ → **We could see the trail.**
- ~~She could swam very well as a child.~~ → **She could swim very well as a child.**

1. My grandfather _____ climb mountains easily.

- a. could
- b. couldn't
- c. can

2. We _____ see the trail because of the fog.

- a. could
- b. couldn't
- c. can't

3. _____ you swim across the river as a child?

- a. Do
- b. Could
- c. Are

4. The guide _____ find the cave in the dark.

- a. could
- b. coulds
- c. was could

5. We _____ (not/start) a campfire because everything was wet.

6. As a child, I _____ (climb) trees very fast.

7. She could swimming very well when she was young. — *True / False*

8. We couldn't find shelter before the storm started. — *True / False*

9. A: _____ you find your way with a compass when you were a scout?

10. B: Yes, I _____. I _____ (read) a compass very well.

11. Make a sentence about the past: mountains / could / climb / easily / my grandfather

Should: giving advice

Should is used to give advice or a recommendation — it does not express obligation. The negative, shouldn't, shows that something is not a good idea.

Should, bir tavsiye ya da öneri vermek için kullanılır; zorunluluk anlatmaz. Olumsuzu shouldn't, bir şeyin iyi bir fikir olmadığını, yapılmamasının önerildiğini gösterir.

When? We use it to give advice about nature trips and dangerous weather: what people should and shouldn't do.

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Doğa gezileri ve tehlikeli hava koşulları için tavsiye verirken kullanılır: ne yapmalı, ne yapmamalı.

Positive

- You should take a compass.
- Hikers should check the forecast.

Negative

- You shouldn't hike alone.
- You shouldn't swim during a storm.

Question

- Should we wear warm clothes?
- Should I take extra water?

Short answers

- Yes, you should. / No, you shouldn't.

Common mistakes

- ~~You should to take a compass.~~ → **You should take a compass.**
- ~~You should hiking alone in a storm.~~ → **You shouldn't hike alone in a storm.**

1. You _____ take a compass and a map on a hike.

- a. should
- b. shouldn't
- c. must

2. You _____ hike alone in extreme weather.

- a. should
- b. shouldn't
- c. have to

3. _____ we wear warm clothes for the trip?

- a. Do
- b. Should
- c. Are

4. Hikers _____ check the weather forecast before they leave.

- a. should
- b. shouldn't
- c. can't

5. You _____ (not/swim) during a storm. It's dangerous.

6. You _____ (bring) extra water on a long hike.

7. You should to check the weather before a hike. — *True / False*

8. Hikers shouldn't ignore storm warnings. — *True / False*

9. A: What _____ we _____ (do) if we see lightning?

10. B: We _____ (find) shelter immediately.

11. You should stay calm during a storm. (*Make it negative advice about panicking.*)